Baramulla and Tangdhar districts of Kashmir. Rescue and relief measures were effected on a war footing under the name Operation Imdaad (Succour). Even though we also suffered casualties along the LoC, and some of our posts were badly hit, my directions were to send out search and rescue mission patrols to the remote areas and give a helping hand to the people in distress. The forward piquet in Tangdhar sector just disappeared from the face of the earth as the fractured edge of the mountain was sliced by nature and tumbled down a few thousand feet.

As a humanitarian gesture, composite relief points were set up by our army for the people of PoK too. These were established at Kaman, Tithwal, Chakan-da-bagh, Roshni and Silkot, so as to facilitate transfer of relief material across the LoC to the Pakistani authorities. 'Pakistan Foreign Minister Khurshid M. Kasuri on Tuesday (11 October 2005) spoke to External Affairs Minister K. Natwar Singh and expressed appreciation for India's assistance to the quake-hit. India's 25-tonne relief supplies, including tents, plastic sheets, blankets, mattresses, food items and medicines, will fly out from New Delhi around midnight Tuesday'.[2] The total count of relief provided was much more, as shown in the news snippet below. The Indian Air Force and army aviation also made a commendable contribution and effected an air bridge from the affected areas to the hospitals in Srinagar and saved many lives.

Further, the army adopted three villages that had been destroyed by the earthquake and were raised from the rubble as model villages. These were Churunda and Tithwal in the valley and another in Poonch area called Khari Karmara. Along with my wife Rohini, I inaugurated the Tithwal model village on 22 June 2006. This village is within earshot of the LoC, with only the turquoise-blue Kishanganga river flowing between PoK and India. I also inaugurated the Churunda model village on 6 October 2006. In these villages we created community development centres, new buildings for primary health centres, roads, pathways, piped water supply, sports fields and schools. Later, the Indian Air Force also adopted a village called Urusa and helped to reconstruct it. The comparison of the spontaneity of the relief and rescue operations on